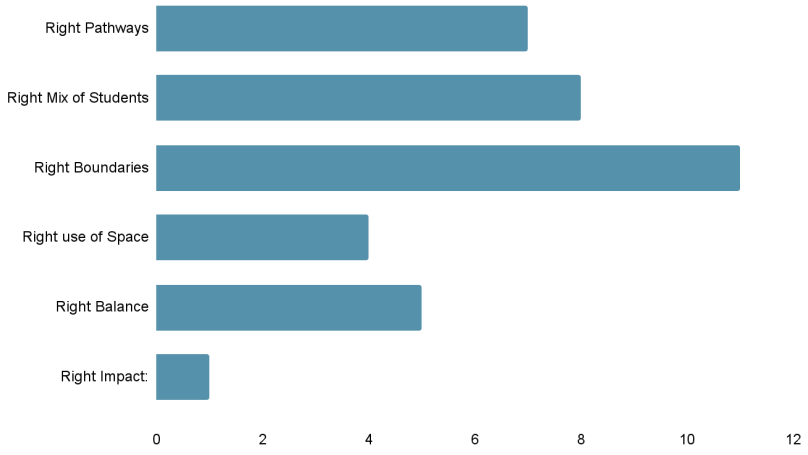
Board Engagement Summary:
Village Table
April 15, 2026

Between 9-15 responses were collected per question at the Village Table engagement session on April 15, 2026. An array of school communities and grade bands were represented, though 87% of respondents were associated with K-5 schools. 27% of participants identified Black/African American, 7% as American Indian/Alaska Native, 20% as Asian, 7% as Hispanic/Latinx, 7% as Pacific Islander, 67% as White, and 7% as Multiracial. A third of respondents have experienced a boundary change in the last 5 years.

Of the six factors in the PPS student assignment policy, 12 members of the Village Table prioritized boundaries that promote safer routes to schools and a sense of community as well as recognize and address natural and human-made barriers, student body demographics, and feeder patterns that allows as many students as possible to continue together from one school level to the next. Chart 1 shows the number of votes each factor received.

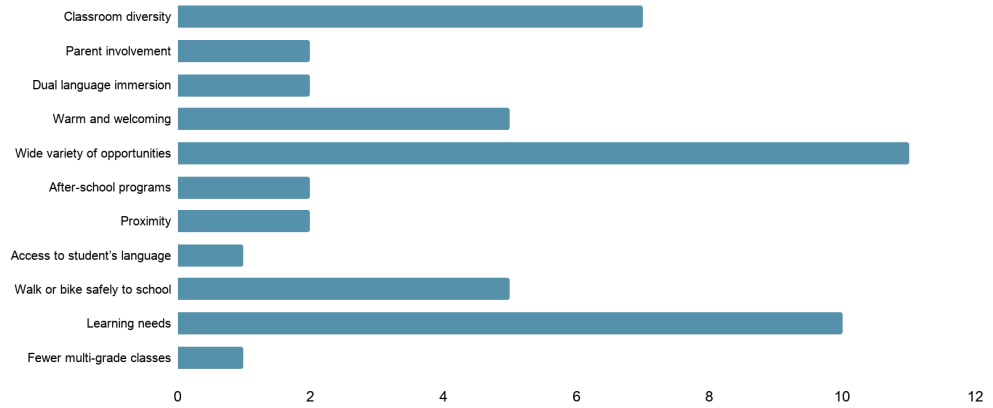
Chart 1:
Responses to the question, "Our Portland Public Schools Student Assignment Policy asks us to consider the following six factors. Please select the three most important factors to consider during program and enrollment balancing across our system."



When asked to rank four factors that make a positive school environment, 12 respondents' top choices were a wide variety of learning opportunities (11), learning alongside students from different backgrounds (7), and access to services that meet every students' learning needs (10). A warm and welcoming school environment (5) and the ability of children to walk or bike safely to school (5) were

equally important to members of the Village Table. Chart 2 shows the number of votes each factor received.

Chart 2:
Responses to the question, "select the top four factors that you think make a positive school environment"



When asked, "what has helped you/your student feel connected as they move from one school to the next?", eight families responded, reporting that maintaining connections with familiar classmates and consistent staff is the most vital factor in feeling supported during transitions caused by boundary shifts, grade-level changes, or building modernizations. Successful transitions were often facilitated by dedicated special education teachers, parent-teacher engagement, and administrative efforts to keep siblings or peer cohorts together.

Finally, Village Table members were asked, "What should leaders understand about your community before making decisions like this?" In response, the VIllage table advocated that the district must look beyond budget numbers to understand the community impact of school changes, particularly for marginalized families whose voices remain underrepresented in the current process. They emphasize that true equity requires protecting the stability of neighborhood programs that have already been weakened by previous transitions. Ultimately, parents are calling for a transparent process that explains the reason behind these decisions.